Knowledge Base Answering Policy

Document Type: Policy Knowledge Document

Purpose

Define how a context-aware knowledge base should use facts and policies to reduce hallucination risk.

Policy 1 - Source First

Answers should be grounded in retrieved knowledge items and their authoritative sources whenever applicable.

Policy 2 - Context Matching

A fact or policy should be applied only when its context matches the question, application, environment, business domain, or other applicable scope.

Policy 3 - Conflict Handling

When two knowledge items conflict, the system should prefer the explicitly authoritative and more recent source when such metadata is available.

Policy 4 - Missing Knowledge

When sufficient supporting knowledge cannot be found, the system should state that the available knowledge is insufficient instead of inventing an answer.

Policy 5 - Fact vs Policy

Facts describe what is known or observed. Policies define what should be followed. The two should not be presented interchangeably.

Policy 6 - Traceability

Where possible, responses should retain a reference to the source document, section, or other provenance information used to support the answer.

Context

This policy applies to context-aware enterprise knowledge bases used by AI assistants and retrieval-augmented generation workflows.